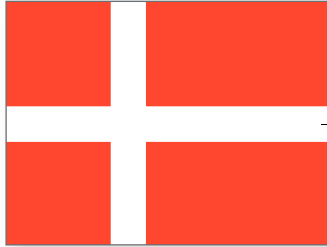


Denmark

Ratio: 28:37 **Adopted:** 1625 **Usage:** National and Civil

According to legend, a red flag with a white cross “appeared as a sign from heaven”



The off-centered cross is the basis for other Scandinavian countries' flags

Europe



Denmark is Europe's oldest kingdom, dating back to the 10th century. The present queen rules under a constitution granted in 1953.

Besides being the oldest monarchy in Europe, Denmark also has the oldest flag, known as the *Dannebrog*, or Danish cloth. Legend says that a blood-red flag with a white cross appeared as a sign from heaven to King Valdemar II during the conquest of Estonia in 1219. In

reality, the flag may have been a gift from the Pope during the Crusades.

THE SCANDINAVIAN CROSS

The flag was originally square, but its design was elongated and the arm of the cross in the fly was extended. It has become a model for other flags.

Overseas Territories



FAEROE ISLANDS

The Faeroe Islands are a self-governing territory of Denmark. The flag has the Norwegian colors in a new arrangement. This recalls that they were once part of Norway.



GREENLAND

Greenland's flag was designed by a local artist and adopted in 1985. In the Danish colors, white represents the ice which covers most of the island and red is for the Sun.